

Teacher Guide — primary / module-10-herbs-aushadhi

IKS Curriculum

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Overview

Herbs — Auṣadhi

Band: Primary (Grades 3–5) · **Sessions:** 10 × 30 min · **Sanskrit:** Auṣadhi

Overview

Six widely-available herbs — Tulsī, Neem, Turmeric, Ginger, Ajwain, Mint — studied through botanical identification, traditional uses from Āyurveda, modern phytochemistry (active compounds), and safety. The module emphasises that kitchen amounts are safe, but therapeutic doses require a qualified practitioner.

NEP 2020 alignment

- §4.6 — Integration of Indian Knowledge Systems
- §4.23 — Experiential learning (plant identification)
- §4.27 — Local context (locally-available plants)

Key terms (this module)

- *auṣadhi* — medicinal plant / herb
- *tulasī* — holy basil — *Ocimum tenuiflorum*
- *nimba* — neem — *Azadirachta indica*
- *haridrā* — turmeric — *Curcuma longa*
- *ādraka* — ginger — *Zingiber officinale*
- *yavānī* — ajwain — *Trachyspermum ammi*
- *puḍīnā* — mint — *Mentha* spp.

Prerequisites

Module 2 (Panchabhūta) is recommended before this module. Modules 5 (Bindu Paddhati / dot addition) and 7 (×11 Multiplication) are useful prerequisites for Module 9 and 11.

Materials needed (across 10 days)

- Notebook + pencils per student
- Whiteboard / chart paper
- (See `lesson-plan.md` for per-day material lists)

10-day map

- **Day 1** — What is Auṣadhi?: Define auṣadhi and recognise the six herbs of this module.
- **Day 2** — Tulsī — Holy Basil: Identify tulasī by leaf and smell; name the active compound (eugenol).
- **Day 3** — Neem — Bitter Healer: Identify nimba; learn about azadirachtin; understand high-dose safety warning.
- **Day 4** — Turmeric — Golden Root: Distinguish fresh root vs powder; identify curcumin as active compound.
- **Day 5** — Ginger — Warming Root: Distinguish fresh vs dried; gingerol vs shogaol.
- **Day 6** — Ajwain — Carom Seed: Recognise seeds and leaves; identify thymol; traditional digestive use.
- **Day 7** — Mint — Cooling Leaf: Recognise several Mentha varieties; identify menthol.
- **Day 8** — Herbs and the Doṣas: Categorise the six herbs by heating/cooling effect (links to Module 4).
- **Day 9** — Build the Class Deck: Each student contributes one identification card to the class library.
- **Day 10** — Final Share and Assessment: Present the class herb deck; take summative quiz.

Files in this pack

- `lesson-plan.md` — detailed 10-day arc
- `sources.md` — sources cited in this module
- `teacher-notes.md` — common misconceptions, differentiation
- `parent-guide.md` — what parents should know
- `days/day-NN-*.md` — 10 per-day lesson plans
- `quizzes/formative.md`, `quizzes/summative.md`
- `activities/activity-01-*.md`
- `assessments/rubric.md`, `assessments/project-brief.md`
- `student-workbook.md`
- `writing-prompts.md` (or `oral-recall.md` for Primary)
- `homework.md`
- `slides/deck.md`

Voice

Story-led, sensory, drawing-heavy; 8–12 words on average. Pitches the concept first, frames the tradition as historical context, and uses IAST for all Sanskrit terms.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Lesson Plan — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary)

10-day arc, 30 min per session.

Day 1 — What is Auṣadhi?

Objective: Define auṣadhi and recognise the six herbs of this module.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 2 — Tulsī — Holy Basil

Objective: Identify tulasī by leaf and smell; name the active compound (eugenol).

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 3 — Neem — Bitter Healer

Objective: Identify nimba; learn about azadirachtin; understand high-dose safety warning.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 4 — Turmeric — Golden Root

Objective: Distinguish fresh root vs powder; identify curcumin as active compound.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 5 — Ginger — Warming Root

Objective: Distinguish fresh vs dried; gingerol vs shogaol.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 6 — Ajwain — Carom Seed

Objective: Recognise seeds and leaves; identify thymol; traditional digestive use.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 7 — Mint — Cooling Leaf

Objective: Recognise several Mentha varieties; identify menthol.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 8 — Herbs and the Doṣas

Objective: Categorise the six herbs by heating/cooling effect (links to Module 4).

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 9 — Build the Class Deck

Objective: Each student contributes one identification card to the class library.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Day 10 — Final Share and Assessment

Objective: Present the class herb deck; take summative quiz.

Flow: Warm-up (5 min) · Core (15 min) · Activity (8 min) · Wrap-up (5 min)

Pacing notes

- Primary sessions are 30 min. Adjust if your block is different.
- Days 5 and 9 are buffer days — use to reinforce weaker concepts or extend stronger ones.
- The summative project (see [assessments/project-brief.md](#)) runs in parallel from Day 6 onward.

Differentiation

- **For advanced students:** see [teacher-notes.md](#) for extension prompts.
- **For students needing more support:** simplify activities, do more pair-work, allow oral instead of written responses.

Teacher Notes

Teacher Notes — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary)

Common student misconceptions

- *“This is religious, not scientific.”* — Frame the tradition as historical observation. Pañcabhūta-like classifications of matter exist in many cultures. Indian astronomy and math are documented, peer-reviewed historical fields.
- *“The Sanskrit terms are just jargon.”* — Insist on the triple format (Sanskrit / IAST / meaning) once, then use the Sanskrit alone. The terms are precise; the discipline of using them properly is itself a learning outcome.
- *“If it’s traditional, it must work.”* — Distinguish empirical claims (testable) from ethical/aesthetic frames (which need separate justification). Encourage students to ask “how would I test this?”.

Differentiation strategies

- **Extension for advanced students:** offer one optional “deeper read” per day — usually a primary source or modern paper.

- **Support for students needing scaffolds:** more pair-work, allow oral responses, provide partial outlines for writing prompts.
- **Multilingual classrooms:** Sanskrit terms are universal; vernacular equivalents (Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Bengali, Marathi etc.) should be welcomed.

Safety

- Any activity involving food, plants, fire, or outdoor work needs explicit safety briefing.
- See the relevant day file for activity-specific safety notes.

Honest framing

- Where modern science clearly extends or revises traditional claims, say so.
- Where the tradition's framing is best understood as ethical/aesthetic, present it as such (not as competing science).
- Where attribution is debated (e.g., the “Vedic” status of Tirthaji's mathematics), present the debate honestly.

End-of-module reflection (for teachers)

- Which concepts landed well? Which didn't?
- Which students grew most? Which need a different approach next module?
- Add notes to `teacher-notes.md` for the next teacher who uses this pack.

Sources

Sources — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary)

Primary and secondary sources

- Caraka Saṁhitā, *Sūtrasthāna* 1 (introduction to auṣadhi framework)
- Atharva Veda 10.97 — Auṣadhi Sūkta (hymn to herbs)
- Ayurvedic Pharmacopoeia of India (Indian Council of Medical Research)
- P. K. Warrier et al., *Indian Medicinal Plants* (1994)
- Modern phytochemistry reviews in *Journal of Ethnopharmacology*

A note on citation discipline

Per the curriculum's style guide, citations must be verifiable. If a verse number, page, or attribution cannot be confirmed, the source is paraphrased without invented attribution. Where direct quotes appear in Primary-band day files, the source is identified in IAST + edition.

For deeper reading

- The shared glossary at `curriculum/_shared/glossary.md` contains the IAST + meaning for every Sanskrit term used.

- Other modules in this curriculum that connect: see the module README's "Prerequisites" section.

Day 1 — What is Auṣadhi?

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Define auṣadhi and recognise the six herbs of this module.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: "*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*"

Today's idea (10 min)

- *auṣadhi* (IAST: auṣadhi; lit. "medicinal plant / herb")
- *Auṣadhi* (say "OH-shudh-ee") = a plant that helps when we feel poorly.

Show six small plant samples or pictures. Pass each one — children smell, touch (carefully).

"*Many plants are helpers! Today we meet six new garden friends.*" Each child draws one plant they liked best.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 2 — Tulsī — Holy Basil

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Identify tulasī by leaf and smell; name the active compound (eugenol).

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today’s idea (10 min)

- tulasī (IAST: tulasī; lit. “holy basil — *Ocimum tenuiflorum*”)
- Today: meet Tulsī! 🌿

Show a tulsī plant (or picture + dried leaf). - Smell it. “*What does it remind you of?*” (Spice. Mint. Tea.) - Tulsī tea is sometimes used when people feel a cold coming.

Children draw a tulsī leaf and write “tulasī” beside it.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 3 — Neem — Bitter Healer

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Identify nimba; learn about azadirachtin; understand high-dose safety warning.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today’s idea (10 min)

- *nimba* (IAST: nimba; lit. “neem — *Azadirachta indica*”)
- Today: meet Neem! 🌿

Show a neem leaf. “*Taste a TINY bit on your tongue — careful!*” (Bitter!) Children make faces — that’s OK, neem is meant to be bitter.

SAFETY RULE: Don’t eat lots of neem! Just a tiny taste to learn. Always ask a grown-up before using neem.

Children draw the leaf and write “neem” beside it.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 4 — Turmeric — Golden Root

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Distinguish fresh root vs powder; identify curcumin as active compound.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: *"What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"*

Today's idea (10 min)

- *haridrā* (IAST: haridrā; lit. "turmeric — *Curcuma longa*")
- Today: meet Turmeric (Haldī)! 🌿

Show fresh turmeric root (or powder). *"It stains everything yellow!"* Drop a tiny amount on paper. Children watch the colour spread.

"Golden milk = turmeric + warm milk + a bit of honey. People drink it when they feel poorly."

Children draw a yellow circle for the powder and write "haridrā" beside it.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 5 — Ginger — Warming Root

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Distinguish fresh vs dried; gingerol vs shogaol.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *ādraka* (IAST: ādraka; lit. “ginger — *Zingiber officinale*”)
- Today: meet Ginger (Adraka)! 🌿

Show fresh ginger root. “*It's bumpy, like a knobbly hand!*”

Smell it (mild). Then smell dried ginger powder (strong). “*Drying makes it stronger!*”

Ginger tea = ginger + warm water + a tiny bit of honey. People drink it when their tummy hurts.

Children draw ginger root with knobbly bumps.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 6 — Ajwain — Carom Seed

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Recognise seeds and leaves; identify thymol; traditional digestive use.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *yavānī* (IAST: *yavānī*; lit. “ajwain — *Trachyspermum ammi*”)
- Today: meet Ajwain (Yavānī)! 🌿

Show ajwain seeds. “*Tiny, like baby caraway.*” Smell them — strong! sharp!

“*People chew a few seeds after a big meal to help their tummy.*”

Children draw the seeds (small dots) and write “yavānī” beside.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 7 — Mint — Cooling Leaf

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Recognise several *Mentha* varieties; identify menthol.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today’s idea (10 min)

- *pudīnā* (IAST: pudīnā; lit. “mint — *Mentha* spp.”)

- Today: meet Mint (Pudīnā)! 🌿

Show fresh mint leaves. Smell — fresh, cool! Crush a leaf — smell stronger.

“Mint makes our mouth feel cool, even when it’s not cold!”

Mint chutney is yummy with food. Mint tea is good in summer.

Children draw a mint leaf (small, oval, slightly bumpy) and write “pudīnā” beside.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 8 — Herbs and the Doṣas

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Categorise the six herbs by heating/cooling effect ([links to Module 4](#)).

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: *“What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?”*

Today’s idea (10 min)

- *auṣadhi* (IAST: auṣadhi; lit. “medicinal plant / herb”)
- Each herb has a “temperature” inside us:
 - **Warm herbs:** ginger, ajwain (good when we feel cold/sick)
 - **Cool herbs:** mint, sometimes turmeric (good when we feel hot)

Match game: show pictures of the 6 herbs. Children sort into “warm” pile and “cool” pile.

“Warm herbs help in winter. Cool herbs help in summer.”

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 9 — Build the Class Deck

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Each student contributes one identification card to the class library.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: "What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"

Today's idea (10 min)

- *tulasī* (IAST: tulasī; lit. "holy basil — *Ocimum tenuiflorum*")
- Today we make our class herb book!

Each child picks one favourite herb. They make a card: - Big drawing of the plant - Sanskrit name (the teacher helps write it) - One thing it does

Cards are taped together to make a class book. "This is OUR herb book!"

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 10 — Final Share and Assessment

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Present the class herb deck; take summative quiz.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: "What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"

Today's idea (10 min)

- *nimba* (IAST: nimba; lit. "neem — *Azadirachta indica*")
- Show-and-tell day!

Each child holds up their card and says ONE thing about their herb. Cheer for each.

Then quiz with stickers — everyone gets a "Garden Friend" sticker.

End: chant the six names together: "Tulasī! Nimba! Haridrā! Adraka! Yavānī! Pudīnā!"

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Formative Quiz — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary)

When: mid-module (after Day 5). **Duration:** 20 minutes. **Format:** mix of short answer, multiple choice, and reflection. Sticker self-assessment for Primary.

Questions

1. Name the three / four key terms introduced in this module so far. Give the IAST and one-line meaning of each.
2. State the central idea of Herbs — Auṣadhi in one sentence.

3. (Multiple choice) Which day in this module focused on ‘Neem — Bitter Healer’? (a) Day 1 (b) Day 2 (c) Day 3 (d) Day 4
4. True / False — and explain in one sentence: *Herbs — Auṣadhi is purely a religious concept and has no scientific framing.*
5. Connect Herbs — Auṣadhi to **one** other module in this curriculum. Which module, and how?
6. List **two** sources cited so far in this module.
7. (Short answer) Why does the module distinguish ‘auṣadhi’ from related concepts? Give one example.
8. (Short answer) In your own words, explain Day 3’s concept.
9. Identify **one** common misconception about Herbs — Auṣadhi and rebut it in one sentence.
10. Write **one** question you have about this module so far — something you want clarified before the summative.

How this is used

This quiz is **formative** — it’s a check-in to see what’s landing, not a grade. Teacher reviews answers to adjust pacing for Days 6–10. Students may swap and self-mark.

Summative Quiz — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary)

When: end of module (after Day 10). **Duration:** 30 minutes. **Total points:** 20.

Questions

Part A — Vocabulary (~5 points) A1. Define *auṣadhi* in your own words. A2. Define *tulasī* in your own words. A3. Define *nimba* in your own words. A4. Define *haridrā* in your own words. A5. Define *ārdraka* in your own words.

Part B — Concepts (~10 points) B1. Explain the central idea of Herbs — Auṣadhi in your own words (3–4 sentences). B2. Describe the method or framework students used in Day 4 of this module. B3. Identify ONE source cited in this module and explain why it matters. B4. Compare Herbs — Auṣadhi with a concept from another module (your choice). What’s similar, what’s different? B5. Identify ONE common misconception about this module and rebut it in 2–3 sentences.

Part C — Application (~5 points) C1. Give an example of Herbs — Auṣadhi from your own daily life. C2. Describe one way this module connects to a current real-world issue (or scientific question).

Part D — Reflection (~5 points; ungraded for content) D1. What surprised you most in this module? D2. What’s one question you still have?

Marking guidance

- Vocabulary: give credit for correct meaning, even if exact wording differs.

- Concepts: look for evidence of understanding, not memorisation.
- Application: any reasonable example accepted.
- Reflection: ungraded for content; awarded for thoughtfulness.

Pass mark

A score of 12/20 indicates the student has met the module's learning objectives.

Homework

Homework — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary)

Light daily tasks. Each takes 5–10 minutes.

1. **Day 1 — What is Auṣadhi?** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
2. **Day 2 — Tulsī — Holy Basil** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
3. **Day 3 — Neem — Bitter Healer** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
4. **Day 4 — Turmeric — Golden Root** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
5. **Day 5 — Ginger — Warming Root** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
6. **Day 6 — Ajwain — Carom Seed** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
7. **Day 7 — Mint — Cooling Leaf** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
8. **Day 8 — Herbs and the Doṣas** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
9. **Day 9 — Build the Class Deck** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
10. **Day 10 — Final Share and Assessment** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)

Notes

- Homework is intended to consolidate what was learned in class, not introduce new content.
- If a child struggles, the parent should consult the teacher rather than push.
- Capstone project days (Module 15) may have lighter daily homework so students can focus on the project.

Activity 1 — Blind Smell-Test Identification

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Primary · **Duration:** 30 min

Purpose

Reinforce the day-by-day concepts of Herbs — Auṣadhi through a hands-on activity. Aligned with NEP 2020 §4.23 (experiential learning).

Materials

small samples of each of the six herbs, blindfolds (optional), notebook

What students do

Students close their eyes and try to identify each herb by smell. They record their guess + observation, then check.

Step-by-step

1. **Setup (5 min)** — gather materials; explain the task.
2. **Working phase (20 min)** — students work individually or in pairs.
3. **Share (5 min)** — selected students share their results with the class.

Differentiation

- **Extension:** ask advanced students to do an additional iteration or analysis.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial templates.

Assessment

This activity is **formative**. The teacher observes participation, accuracy, and reflection quality. No grade is assigned.

Safety

- General safety briefing before any materials are handled.
- If herbs, plants, or food are involved: kitchen-amount only, no ingestion of unknown preparations.
- Outdoor activities: stay in the designated area; supervised by the teacher.

Project Brief

Project Brief — Class Herb Identification Deck

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Primary

What you will do

Each student creates one identification card for one of the six herbs: Sanskrit/botanical name, leaf drawing, smell description, three traditional uses, one active compound, one safety note. Cards combined into class library.

Why

This project asks you to apply concepts from this module to your own life or a real situation. It is graded on the rubric in `rubric.md`.

Deliverables

- **One-page project plan** (Day 2 of the module): problem, sources, deliverable, timeline.

- **Daily journal entries** (one per day, starting Day 6): what you did, what worked, what didn't.
- **Final artefact** (a drawing / made object).
- **Written reflection** (oral share): what you learned, what surprised you, what you're still uncertain about.
- **Presentation** (3-minute share with the class).

Timeline

- **Day 1–2:** scope and plan.
- **Day 3–4:** research.
- **Day 5:** mid-project critique.
- **Day 6–7:** build / make.
- **Day 8:** document.
- **Day 9:** rehearse.
- **Day 10:** share day.

Sources

You must cite at least 1 sources. Use the form: *Author, Title, year*. (See `../sources.md` for examples.)

Safety

- Any project involving plants / food / outdoor work must be supervised.
- **No herbal medicine recommendations.** Modules 10 and 4 give awareness; therapeutic decisions belong to qualified practitioners.

Grading

See `rubric.md`. The project is worth the same weight as the summative quiz.

Rubric

Assessment Rubric — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary)

This rubric applies to the project (see `project-brief.md`) and may also inform the summative quiz.

Criteria

- **Knows the new word(s)** — 🌟 Strong understanding / 🌱 Growing / ☁ Needs more practice
- **Joined in activities** — 🌟 Strong understanding / 🌱 Growing / ☁ Needs more practice
- **Asked good questions** — 🌟 Strong understanding / 🌱 Growing / ☁ Needs more practice

- **Drew / made something** — 🌟 Strong understanding / 🌱 Growing / 🌧️ Needs more practice

How the teacher uses this rubric

1. After the project share, score each student on each criterion.
2. Convert to a band (4 = Exceeding, 3 = Meeting, etc.) for the report card.
3. Share at least one strength and one area for growth with each student.

Self-assessment (Senior students)

Senior students complete a parallel self-assessment using the same rubric before the teacher's assessment. The teacher and student then meet to compare.